Zindabad' on a regular basis, right up to the time of his own death by hanging. The imitation of Auguste Vaillant was not in vain. The statement on behalf of Bhagat Singh and B.K Dutt by Asaf Ali declared that 'revolution is an inalienable right of mankind' and that 'freedom is an imperishable birth-right of all'. It was immediately reported on by the leading national newspapers of the day.

This was despite the fact that the magistrate had put in place rigid censorship controls that would curtail the making of manifesto speeches. The authorities viewed the trial in the context of the growth of communism in the 1920s. Left-wing radical groups were gaining strength in Europe and in America. Their activities had to be rigorously controlled and restricted. The authorities' fear was not allayed by the accused defiantly entering the courtroom with shouts of 'Inquilab Zindabad', making Bhagat Singh's name synonymous with this slogan. To this day, from student protests to farmer's revolts, 'Long live the revolution' is the one slogan that is associated with the name of Bhagat Singh.

So, on 9 June 1929, F.B. Pool ruled that, provided that sections of Bhagat Singh's speech could be 'expunged' from the record, he would allow it as the magistrate in charge. He reasoned that, given that the words in question had no impact on the case he had to decide, the offending words in Bhagat Singh's statement 'cannot be referred to here, nor, being irrelevant, could they affect the case'. The magistrate's entreaties, however, were in vain. No sooner had the trial started than Bhagat Singh's written testimony was in the public domain. It was widely available to all as it had been leaked to the press. Copies were even translated into Bengali and Gujarati and then circulated in revolutionary circles. It is not difficult to see why. When Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt called for revolution, in one of the expunged passages from their speech, what they were calling for was not a revolution of blood-letting but a revolution of ideas.